

more expensive than the rest of the netbooks at some Rs. 27,000, but it comes with a fancier design and a screen that runs at 1366x768 instead of the standard 1024x600 or 1024 x 576 resolutions on other 9 and 10-inch displays. This means slightly fine and crisper images, but text can be a bit of a problem.

A few other things to keep in mind while choosing a netbook is the placement of the keys on the keyboard. Before of the restricted space, manufacturers might compromise on some of the keys by making them smaller or removing them altogether. I've seen weird positioning of the mouse buttons on the trackpad. The old Acer Aspire One had tiny directional keys. We've seen the MSI Wind with the Function key placed at one corner instead of the [Ctrl] key. These are things you can live with but initially, you'll find this change very annoying.

The operating system on these netbooks is the other factor to keep in mind. With Windows 7 out, look for it when you're selecting your netbook. Most netbooks sell with Windows XP Home pre-installed. Netbooks with Linux or no operating system at all should typically be a bit cheaper than these. Also, almost every netbook today comes with 1 GB of RAM. Having 2 GB is a lot better. Make sure the model allows upgrading memory to 2 GB.

One of the developments taking place is with the platform itself. Netbooks running NVIDIA's Ion platform are expected to be here soon. They still use the Atom processor, but with the superior graphics solution, the Ion will drastically improve the graphics performance and HD playback capabilities. If you're thinking of purchasing a netbook right away, it might be worth waiting for.

BenQ U121



Sony VAIO W

